

ROUNDUP

September 2023

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THE LEADERSHIP COMPASS



Parul Soni

Founder Secretary General

Championing women entrepreneurs makes perfect business sense. We cultivate an environment where ambition meets opportunity, where expertise is celebrated, and success knows no boundaries. By fostering a nurturing ecosystem, we pave the future that is not only empowering but inherently equitable, & enriching.



Dr. Ambika Sharma

Chief Executive Officer

Empowerment begins with embracing your uniqueness. Women entrepreneurs don't just break glass ceilings; they build new heights, redefine success, & inspire generations. Keep forging your path with resilience, innovation, & unwavering determination. Together, we will create a world where every woman's entrepreneurial dream knows no bounds.

Welcoming our Global Champions!



Anjum Malik
State President
Texas, USA

Anjum is the Executive Director of the Global Impact Initiative and the Managing Partner at the Alhambra US Chamber. She is known for her tenacity, problem-solving skills, and collaborations. [Read more](#)



Beth Hendricks
State President
Idaho, USA

Beth is the Owner of Full House Productions LLC. As an educator, her passion for education extends to online platforms, offering courses in marketing, advertising, and public relations. [Read more](#)



Liz Whitehead
State President
Washington DC, USA

Liz Whitehead is the CEO of 12PointFive, a consultancy specializing in diverse business growth through strategic development. She is an accomplished global networker and speaker. [Read more](#)



Lynn Whitbeck
State President
Washington, USA

Lynn is the Founder & CEO of Petite2Queen. Business owners and entrepreneurs hire Lynn to ignite winning sales, because most are chasing down leads, lack client retention, conversion, and profit. [Read more](#)



Neris Mercedes Ramos Acevedo
Country President
Dominican Republic

As the CEO & Founder of NGestiónRD, Neris excels in consultancy, women's entrepreneurship, and family enterprises. Her dedication towards business and collaboration is truly commendable. [Read more](#)



TOGETHER WE THRIVE

ABWCI is working towards connecting women entrepreneurs, providing opportunities for collaboration and partnership, sharing knowledge and best practices, and advocating for policies and programs that strengthens entrepreneurial ecosystem.



African Women's Movement (AWM) is on a mission to be a catalyst and agent that influences nations and empowers its women to thrive in leadership spaces, across all spheres of society.



[Read more](#)

CNI's vision is to play a leading role in making the Nepal's industrial sector vibrant, resilient as well as globally competitive and to promote an investment-friendly environment to achieve a sustainable double-digit economic growth.



[Read more](#)

VUCE is the executing unit of the Argentine Foreign Trade Single Window Regime. VUCE aims to facilitate the access of SMEs to international trade and access to strategic foreign trade information with benefits for women and diversities.



[Read more](#)

CWEA's vision is to support the growth of women-owned businesses in Cambodia. They are the voice of 500+ women entrepreneurs & are generating 15000+ jobs with the aim to facilitate the growth of businesses in which women are constructively involved.



[Read more](#)

PHDCCI works at the grass roots level with strong linkages for propelling progress, harmony and integrated development of the Indian economy. They have been working for the promotion of Indian industry, trade and entrepreneurship for the past 118 years.



PHD CHAMBER
OF COMMERCE AND INDUSTRY

[Read more](#)



NETWORKED GLOBALLY



ARGENTINA

- Dr. Graciela De Oto, Country President, Argentina conferred with the prestigious Calcutta Award.
- Dr. Graciela De Oto attended the exhibition on, "India, Infinite Magic," which was organised as a tribute to the rich culture, history, and diversity of India.



BANGLADESH

- Parul Soni, Founder Secretary General spoke at the Business Summit on "Business is all about connecting the world within a minute" alongside Global Ambassador Dr M Haider Uzzaman.



BRUNEI DARUSSALAM

- Hajah Zainab binti Haji Ali, Country President, Brunei Darussalam conferred with the Asia's Woman Leaders Award by World Women Leadership Congress and Awards in Singapore.



CAMBODIA

- The Honorary Consulate Office of Cambodia in India facilitated a women's delegation to Cambodia with ABWCI. 55 Indian women entrepreneurs traveled to Siem Reap for B2B networking sessions, buyer-seller meets and panel discussions.



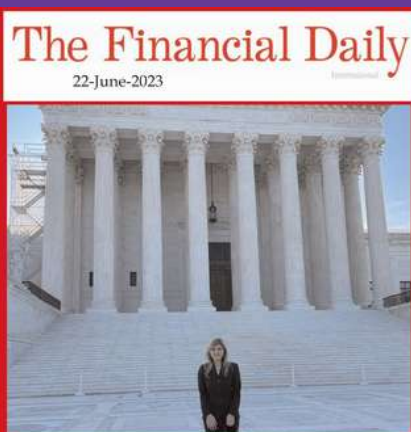
INDIA

- Twinkle Soni, Member- ABWCI, curated special discount cards for the ABWCI network in New Delhi.
- Kavita Rajesh, State President, Telangana & Andhra Pradesh was at the first conference of legislators in India aimed at extending their role as elected representatives. ABWCI presented a concept on setting up WEECs (Women Empowerment and Entrepreneurship Centers) to scale up women led development at the grassroots.
- Kavita Rajesh was a speaker at the National Conference on Women Entrepreneurship in Hyderabad, India.





NETWORKED GLOBALLY



MALAYSIA

- To enhance the outreach of ABWCI to the thriving community of women entrepreneurs in Kuala Lumpur, a networking session was organised by ABWCI@Malaysia.

NIGERIA

- Country President, Nigeria, Ayodeji Meghbope spoke at an information session by FATE Foundation. The aim of the session was to share the value propositions of ABWCI with women entrepreneurs.

PAKISTAN

- Tara Uzra Dawood, Country President, Pakistan sworn into the bar of the Supreme Court of the United States of America.

PERU

- Neris Mercedes Ramos Acevedo, Country President, Dominican Republic was invited as a speaker for an event on, 'The role of women in the implementation of the SDGs'. The objective of this event was to create visibility around women empowerment in the implementation of the 2030 agenda.

UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

- Larisa B. Miller, Global Ambassador featured in the 'World Woman Magazine' as a 'World Changer'.
- Larisa B. Miller honoured with the Global Leadership Award at the Global Business Forum's EuroWoman 2023 in Glasgow, Scotland (UK).
- Liz Whitehead, State President, Washington DC, USA honoured with WBE Star Award 2023.
- Odino Faccia, Global Ambassador is on a journey to highlight the importance of peace, harmony and unity in the world through his music. He and his team organised a Concert for Peace at the California State University of Fullerton, USA.



OFFICIAL ANNOUNCEMENT



W20 INDIA announces ABWCI as
Knowledge and Network partners



G20 is the premier forum for international economic cooperation. It plays an important role in shaping and strengthening global architecture and governance on all major international economic issues.

India has held the Presidency of the **G20** from 1 December 2022 to 30 November 2023.

W20 is the official **G20** engagement group focused on gender equity. Its primary objective is to ensure that gender considerations are mainstreamed into **G20** discussions and translate into the **G20** Leaders' Declaration as policies and commitments that foster gender equality and women's economic empowerment.

The Janbhagidari events were designed to create awareness amongst stakeholders to create awareness about **G20**.

As W20 India's proud knowledge partner and a global chamber of commerce, ABWCI is committed to furthering the agenda of women in leadership and women led development to transform, thrive & transcend.

W20 INCEPTION MEETING

ABWCI's partnership with the W20 started with the participation of women leaders in the W20 Inception Meeting held in Aurangabad, India on February 26-27, 2023. At the meeting, ABWCI was represented by Ayodeji Megbope, Country President, Nigeria and Ayesha AKHTER, Member, Bangladesh.



W20 MEETING IN JAIPUR

Team ABWCI participated in the W20 meeting held in Jaipur, committing towards the evolution of development for women to women led development. The two-day dialogue was themed, "Women-Led Development: Leveraging Women's Untapped Potential to Accelerate an Inclusive and Sustainable Future".



W20 SUMMIT AT MAHABALIPURAM

Team ABWCI participated in the W20 Summit held in Mahabalipuram, Tamil Nadu, India. The summit revolved around the themes of trade, care economy and women empowerment on a policy level. This Summit came up with an extensive Communique to advance Women-Led Development.





The vision of W20 is to create a world of equality & equity where every woman lives with dignity.

THE W20 COMMUNIQUE

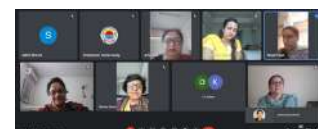


#Women20 Summit held in July, presented a comprehensive communique to advance women-led development.

Women 20 2023 (W20) calls upon G20 leaders to place women and girls as the drivers of the 2023 Presidency theme of One Earth, One Family, One Future – Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam



Additional chief secretary of planning department Shalini Rajneesh, W20 Chair Sandhya Purecha, K Ratnaprabha, founder president of Ubuntu consortium and others show the 'W' symbol at the 'WOW' (women-led development through entrepreneurship and empowerment) programme at FKCCI in Bengaluru on Thursday. DH PHOTO/B K JANARDHAN



WOW: WOMEN-LED DEVELOPMENT THROUGH EMPOWERMENT AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP

ABWCI proudly partnered with FKCCI Bengaluru and Ubuntu Consortium to support the event under the aegis of G20/W20. Our Founder Secretary General, Mr. Parul Soni moderated the panel on "Policy recommendation for creating an enabling ecosystem for women entrepreneurs."

SHE LEADS: A VISION FOR FUTURE

ABWCI and Women's Studies Research Centre at Kurukshetra University in collaboration with Stree Shakti, organised a one day online training programme. This programme was a W20 #JanBhagidari event that aimed at strengthening women's leadership in India and witnessed active participation from ABWCI's Leadership.

EMPOWERING GRASSROOTS WOMEN ENTREPRENEURS

ABWCI organised this W20 #JanBhagidari event in partnership with Divinpro and WICCI. The event was aimed towards unlocking economic growth & sustainability for all. The panelists also talked about the pivotal role of grassroot women entrepreneurs in achieving sustainable economic growth and gender equality which is one of the key priorities of G20/W20.



[Click here to watch the video](#)

BREAKING THE GLASS CEILING

ABWCI organised a captivating panel discussion titled, "Breaking the Glass Ceiling" under the aegis of the G20/W20 Secretariat and **#WomenInVyapaar**. The panel discussion was a W20 **#JanBhagidari** event powered by Women Inspiring Network (WIN) and supported by Thinkthrough Consulting (TTC). Women changemakers and digital content curators shared their personal experiences to inspire the audience to push their limits in search of excellence. The discussions were passionate, insightful and provided guidance for the next generation.

LAUNCH OF THE SHAKTI CART

The Shakti Cart is a livelihood cart specially designed for the economic inclusion of women street vendors to increase their visibility and mobility in public spaces. The cart was inaugurated at the all India premier of the mainstream Bollywood movie, Ghoomer. ABWCI is proud to be associated with 'Shakti Cart', a Make In India initiative by PVR NEST, conceptualized and designed by Desmania Designed for Good. This supports the vision to enable women's business acumen and ambitions with relevant opportunities. At this event, ABWCI and PVR Nest also presented a CSR film on "Building Safe Cities for Women and Children".

#WOMENINVYAPAAR AT THE EQUALITY LOUNGE®

Dr. Ambika Sharma, CEO of ABWCI presented her thoughts at a panel on "Claiming Your Agency: How Women Are Culture Changers In and Outside of the Home" at the **#EqualityLounge** curated by The Female Quotient.

The experience sharing revolved around balancing cultural roots and career aspirations; women reasserting their agency; women's economic empowerment ; and, how can embracing cultural diversity amplify Indian women's contributions to global conversations and initiatives.

At the panel, Dr. Sharma highlighted the initiatives of ABWCI under the aegis of G20/W20.



GLOBAL FOOD SECURITY SUMMIT 2023

ABWCI proudly supported The Global FoodBanking Network (GFN) and Thinkthrough Consulting (TTC) in organizing the Global Food Security Summit 2023 (GFSS 2023) under the aegis of India's G20 presidency.

The aim of GFSS 2023 was to raise awareness about Food Banking, and its significant role in promoting food security and reducing food loss and food waste globally.

The summit witnessed a dynamic all-women panel discussion that comprised of visionaries from different domains and organisations such as Government of Karnataka, UN Women, The Global FoodBanking Network, Heifer International, ABWCI, and Nectar Fresh, coming together to explore the critical role women play in advancing food and nutrition security.

ABWCI's Country Presidents from India and Nepal, Chayaa Nanjappa and Chhaya Sharma were a part of the summit.

Our Founder Secretary General, Parul Soni and CEO, Dr. Ambika Sharma highlighted the role of women entrepreneurs in food security.

Jasneet Kaur, Founder, Bllue Apron and Member - ABWCI, curated customized hampers for all the speakers and participants at the summit.

[Click here for our CEO's message](#)





PRESENTING #WOMENINVYAPAAR

WOMEN *in* VYAPAAR

As a proud W20 knowledge partner and a global chamber of commerce, ABWCI brings to you **#WomenInVyapaar**, a global initiative for supporting and creating women - centric entrepreneurial ecosystems.

#WomenInVyapaar aims to

- Create a robust community of women entrepreneurs
- Provide access to investment capital & trade networks
- Enable entrepreneurial education
- Policy advocacy for women - centric global entrepreneurial ecosystems worldwide

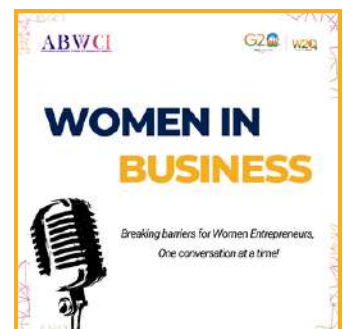
#WomenInVyapaar in Action



I Am Where I am is an informal chat show based on candid conversations between women entrepreneurs to break barriers and shatter myths once conversation at a time.



Women Shaping Trade Futures is an engaging trialogue with women leaders to share how women entrepreneurs are shaping the future of trade and creating an impact globally.



Women in Business is a dialogue series that brings together seasoned women entrepreneurs and industry experts to support the next generation of entrepreneurs through experience sharing and inspirational narratives.

✓ CHECKLIST FOR FOUNDERS & CEO'S



DHRUV MANCHANDA
Legal Advisor

"Have you ever thought why do legal consultations cost so much?"

I recently asked this question to a founder of a technology-based startup I was recently conversing with. The response I received was,

"Well, prevention is always better than cure, I would say."

It will cost 10x the amount if you skimp out on the important compliances.

Here is a brief checklist of agreements and contracts that will help you save your money later:

- ✓ **Confidentiality and Non-Disclosure Agreements (NDAs)**
- ✓ **Founder Agreements**
- ✓ **Client Agreements**
- ✓ **Employment Agreements and Offer Letters**
- ✓ **Service Agreements with Freelancers and Consultants**
- ✓ **Non-Competition and Non-Solicitation Agreement**
- ✓ **Vendor Agreements**
- ✓ **Agreements with Investors**
- ✓ **Software Licensing Agreements**
- ✓ **Data Protection and Privacy Policies**





WHAT'S BREWING

**WOMEN
VYAPAAR**

STAY TUNED FOR MORE UPDATES!

BUSINESS BEYOND BORDERS 2023



Business Beyond Borders: International event for women in B2B/B2C, offering networking, market expansion, export expertise, engaging panels, workshops, and VIVIDHA - The Festive Exhibition for cross-border showcasing.

SAMAAVESHAN 2023

ABWCI is a proud knowledge partner at Samaaveshan, NHRDN's DEIB Summit. The theme of the current year's Summit is to enable and encourage how DEIB can help individuals in everyday life.



CONCERT FOR PEACE



Odino Faccia, Global Ambassador is on a journey to highlight the importance of peace, harmony and unity in the world through his music.

BUSINESS SUPPORT SERVICES FOR WOMEN (BSSW)

BSSW is ABWCI's initiative to enhance access to professional knowledge and services related to accounts, taxation, documentation, governance, and compliances for women entrepreneurs. One of the objectives of BSSW is to extend support in making women entrepreneurs investor-ready and assisting them to scale up their businesses.

INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE IN SINGAPORE

ABWCI will be hosting it's first International Summit in Singapore in 2024 with Class Living representing the Singapore chapter of ABWCI.

CONTACT US

INFO@ABWCI.ORG



SCAN TO LEARN MORE

**Envisioning Tomorrow,
Embracing Opportunities**